

nothing—is so much fun for many of us. But we naturally take on more infrastructure as we move along in our lives and careers.

If you're like Ray and his wife, for example, you and your spouse both work full-time jobs. As soon as you can afford it, you hire someone to clean the house, mow the grass, and wash the cars. If you've got small children, a daily babysitter makes life easier. You begin to work late and the older kids stay after school. That's when an extra refrigerator full of frozen, cooked food comes in handy. Trips to buy groceries become harder to squeeze in. An extra freezer means you can stock up without worrying if there's room to stash everything.

You and your spouse travel on business, so you each own several pieces of versatile luggage. You keep extra toothbrushes, deodorant sticks, and hairbrushes to make sure you can pack in a hurry. You never know when you'll get to the cleaners, so you have more suits and shirts, more dresses and blouses, than you'd otherwise need. You carry extra money, credit cards, and traveler's checks to be prepared when your plans change.

When you reach your 40s or 50s you buy a duplicate set of golf clubs. That way you can leave one at the country club and another in the trunk of your car. You buy a Mercedes but keep the Honda for emergencies. Maybe you put a tennis court in your backyard because you're too busy to arrange games at the tennis club. But you keep your club membership because you may want to play tournaments.

After a while the infrastructure seems to cause more hassle than the hassle it was designed to eliminate. Rather than relax on Saturday mornings, you get up early to get the cars washed, sweep the tennis court, wipe off the patio furniture, move the refrigerators around, straighten up the work shop, add pool chemicals, interview a new gardener, and go shopping. You feel out of control of your life because you're out of control of the infrastructure you set up to help you.